HI! MY NAME IS AI

As digital teammates enter the workforce, they could fundamentally alter how IT services companies work and make money

BY **SHELLEY SINGH**

ILLUSTRATIONS BY **NILANJAN DAS/AI**

A HIGHLY SKILLED junior programmer lives inside your computer's terminal. It doesn't just suggest text. It takes on reasoning-heavy tasks and handles entire programming chores from start to finish—fixing bugs, updating legacy files, and cleaning messy codebases. That's e AI agent Claude Code. AI agents from platforms like Cognition Labs Devin act as fully autonomous, cloud-hosted software engineers capable of running entire IT projects independently. Tools like GitHub Copilot operate as seamless code-completion helpers, sitting next to the user to instantly guess and write the next lines of code, translate languages, or build tests. Closer home, at Tech Mahindra, agents are being deployed in IT operations to resolve alarms and incidents, and across the software-development lifecycle for requirements such as gathering, coding, and documentation. They are also used in customer service where they can process spoken or transcribed conversations and act on them.

For years, programmers used automation to speed up mechanical parts of their jobs. Now, the next step in automation is here. AI agents are beginning to write code, resolve customer complaints, monitor networks, and process transactions. The paradox is striking: human coders at IT services companies are working overtime to train AI agents to match human capabilities—yet those very agents are now competent enough to work alongside the engineers who built and trained them!

Nikhil Malhotra, Chief AI and Innovation Officer, Tech Mahindra, says, "AI agents now manage tasks such as first-level IT troubleshooting, software code